

Classification Notes and Venn Diagram

This is Mrs. Finch's fill-in notetaking guide for the classification unit in Zoology: a warm-up plus ten numbered blanks about how scientists name and sort living things. Her header on the guide says the notes are for his own use and do NOT get turned in. The Classroom assignment it belongs to is titled W-Classification Notes and Venn Diagram, 15 points, due Sep 16, so a Venn diagram goes with it, but the guide itself does not describe that part.

1 Warm-up question (not numbered)

If you would have been an early scientist or settler, what is the one food, plant, or animal that you would have invented or discovered? And why?

His to supply. His own pick. Name one real food, plant, or animal, then one sentence on why it would have mattered to people. Two sentences is enough.

- His own answer
- Two sentences

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

This is a hook question with no right answer. Anything real works: potatoes, chickens, coffee, honeybees, corn. If he stalls, ask him what he would not want to live without, and write that down.

Her header says: fill in, keep for your own notes, you do NOT need to turn in. So the guide itself is not collected. Worth knowing there is a conflict here: Classroom still lists a 15 point assignment called W-Classification Notes and Venn Diagram as missing. Ask her what she actually wants handed in.

2 1. The science of naming and classifying organisms

The science of naming and classifying organisms is called:

WRITE THIS • 1 WORDS

Taxonomy

- One word

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Taxonomy means sorting living things into groups and giving each group a name. A scientist who does this work is a taxonomist.

Some books call the same field systematics. Taxonomy is the word her blank is looking for.

3 2. How long ago Aristotle organized a system

Aristotle organized a system of classification, how long ago?

WRITE THIS · 4 WORDS

About 2,000 years ago

- Round number

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Almost every biology textbook rounds this to about 2,000 years ago, and that is what her blank wants. The real figure is bigger: Aristotle lived from about 384 to 322 BC, so roughly 2,350 years.

If she asks what his system was: he grouped animals by where they lived, land, water and air.

4 3. Who developed binomial nomenclature

The system of binomial nomenclature (we use now) was developed by:

WRITE THIS · 5 WORDS

Carolus Linnaeus (or Carl Linnaeus)

- Name to spell

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Binomial nomenclature just means two-name naming. Bi is two, nomen is name. Every organism gets a two-word name.

He was a Swedish scientist who published the system in the 1700s, and he is often called the father of taxonomy. Linnaeus is the part worth practicing to spell.

5 4. First letter of the genus

The first letter of the genus is always:

WRITE THIS · 4 WORDS

Capitalized (a capital letter)

- One word

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The genus is the first word of the two-word name, and it is the broader group.

This rule never changes, even in the middle of a sentence.

6 5. First letter of the species

The first letter of the species is always:

WRITE THIS · 4 WORDS

Lowercase (a small letter)

- One word
- Pairs with 4

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

The species word is never capitalized, even when it is named after a person or a place.

Both words are italicized when typed and underlined when written by hand. Alex writes by hand, so he should underline both words.

7 6. The scientific name for humans

The scientific name for humans is correctly written as:

WRITE THIS · 2 WORDS

Homo sapiens

- Capitals matter
- Underline both words

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Capital H on Homo, lowercase s on sapiens. Underline both words when writing by hand. Typed, they would be in italics.

This question is really questions 4 and 5 combined. The common mistake is writing homo Sapiens or Homo Sapiens.

8 7. The language scientific names are written in

Scientific names are written in the language of ___ and give biologists a common way of communicating, regardless of the language they speak.

WRITE THIS · 1 WORDS

Latin

- One word

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Latin is not anybody's everyday language anymore, so the words do not drift or change meaning. That stability is the whole point.

A scientist in Japan and a scientist in Brazil both write Homo sapiens, so nobody has to translate. Some names use Greek word parts, but the convention is still called Latin.

9 8. The two parts of a scientific name

What 2 parts make up a Scientific Name?

WRITE THIS · 8 WORDS

Genus name and species name, in that order.

- Order matters

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Genus is the wider group that several close relatives share. Species is the one specific kind inside that group.

Dogs are *Canis familiaris* and wolves are *Canis lupus*. Same genus, *Canis*, so they are close relatives. Different species.

10 9. The seven categories in order (a through g)

What are the seven categories of classification in their proper order? (a through g)

WRITE THIS · 14 WORDS

a. Kingdom b. Phylum c. Class d. Order e. Family f. Genus g. Species

- Memory trick
- Order matters

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Each step down is narrower. Kingdom is the biggest bucket with millions of organisms. Species is the smallest, just one kind.

Memory trick, for his head and not for the paper: King Philip Came Over For Good Spaghetti. The first letters match: King (Kingdom), Philip (Phylum), Came (Class), Over (Order), For (Family), Good (Genus), Spaghetti (Species). Any sentence with those seven letters works, and one he makes up himself sticks better.

11 10. The definition being described

A biological ___ is a group of actually or potentially interbreeding natural populations that are reproductively isolated from other such groups.

WRITE THIS · 1 WORDS

Species

- One word
- Ties back to 8

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

Plain-language version: a species is a group that can breed with each other and produce young that can also have young of their own, and that does not breed with outside groups.

Reproductively isolated means kept separate so they do not interbreed, whether by distance, timing, behavior, or biology.

12 Venn diagram (the other half of the assignment)

Compare two animals on a Venn diagram.

His to supply. Two overlapping circles. Left circle: traits only the first animal has. Right circle: traits only the second has. Middle: traits both share. He fills it in once he knows which two animals.

- His own answer
- Short phrases

BACKGROUND, FOR YOU

What is confirmed: the Classroom assignment is titled W-Classification Notes and Venn Diagram, 15 points, due Sep 16.

What is not confirmed: which two animals get compared. The notetaking guide file has the ten questions and nothing else, so the Venn instructions are not in anything we can read. He or Jonathan needs the Classroom post itself.

A Venn diagram is two overlapping circles. Anything true of only one animal goes in that animal's own part. Anything true of both goes in the middle where the circles cross.

Gap. The Venn diagram compares two stuffed animals and includes a Stuffed Animal Relay Race, per Finch's Classroom post. It is an in-class activity, so it cannot be completed at home.

Gap. Her guide says these notes are NOT collected, yet Classroom still lists this as a missing 15-point assignment. Worth asking her what she actually wants turned in.

Built from the teachers' own files in Alex's Google Drive and Google Classroom, pulled 20 September 2026. Every answer was generated from those files and then fact checked by a separate pass. The blue blocks are sized to fit a worksheet box; the grey text is context for you.